

OpenSolaris 2009.06

Soon to see light from SUN

OpenSolaris is an open source operating system based on Solaris from Sun Microsystems. This is a huge community-driven operating system that is governed by Sun. The latest version of OpenSolaris titled 2009.06 should be out by the



opensolaris

time you read this, and is aimed at users, developers, as well as deployers.

Firefox 3.1 beta comes preinstalled with this OS. Along with that users can quickly backup directories using Time Slider – a new application that allows users to view graphs of what they have been up to on the PC, and where they have spent most of their time. The OS also adds support for network virtualisation and Sun has also provided the OS for laptops. The final build is due around the time you read this, stay tuned for our impressions of it.

Take the next bwarrk@#\$sstt

Global Positioning System (GPS) has recently picked up in India, but the bad news is that it might not last that long, worldwide. The satellite system that forms the basis of its operation has been maintained by the US Air Force since early 1990, but with the current lack of funding and some internal mismanagement, the service might not survive till next year.

These satellites were supposed to be replaced as early as 1997, but no such steps were taken to see this through.

So whose really going to suffer from this? Men who refuse to ask for directions,

for starters. However, most application developers who have made GPS-based applications for mobile phones and sundry GPS devices will also be tearing their hair out.

US Government officials foresee failing GPS devices that will give millions of users incorrect directions. But people are certain that the US Government will wake up and

do something to prevent this from happening, or at least do something before things get so serious that people need to carry maps on, gasp, paper...

The good thing here is that India, Russia, and China already have the ball rolling on expanding satellite navigation technologies and resources.

Meanwhile, if you get lost with your failing GPS device in tow, just roll down your window and ask somebody.

The drama unfolds: always bet on Duke

3D Realms (3DR) has been working on *Duke Nukem Forever* (DNF) for, well, forever – over a decade and then some. May 6th saw a halt to their development

activities though, as they had to lay off the entire development team. This meant no DNF, and thus upset the would-be game's publisher – Take-Two. So much so that the publisher slapped a lawsuit on 3DR.

The facts here are that Take-Two never paid 3DR any money in relation to DNF – no advance, nor signing bonus. Take-Two has actually paid 3DR US \$2.5 million for another game that is still under wraps. So why exactly is Take-Two making so much fuss over 3DR and *Duke Nukem* then? Well the reason is that they paid GT Interactive US \$12 million to obtain the rights to publish DNF, but now since the development has stopped, they have been left with no other option. Of course Take-Two did try to buy the game and the development team from 3DR, but the terms of this contract were unacceptable to the developers.

The fans, meanwhile, are in a tizzy – some gamers are happy that the game won't completely die, but others feel that it might take another decade to launch! Some people think 3DR should just give up the development rights to Take-Two, but others want the original developers to keep that *Duke Nukem* magic alive.

For all you know, this drama might unfold into a new game. But right now, who do you think is really at loss here? We, the gamers who want to get our hands on *Duke Nukem Forever*, of course!



Intel shrinks

Not the company, but the chips that they make. Intel is working on a top secret project called Medfield. The name was leaked by one of the engineers working in their Austin office. Intel is also working on 'Moorestown' which is an Atom-like processor that has two chips and is supposed to consume even less power than the Atom chips do.

Intel is changing its direction and is looking towards the consumer electronics and mobile phone market. With Intel's stock down by 31 per cent in the last 12 months, they are trying hard to break into this sector and excel.

Now the Moorestown processors aren't small enough to fit into mobile phones; that's where 'Medfield' comes in.

The thought behind this new shift is that with evolving technologies, mobile phones are now able to do what computers can. Intel already makes around US \$2 billion a year from embedded chips present in medical devices, cars and other such devices. But now they plan to spread Medfield to all consumer electronics ranging from mobile phones to MP3 players even to household appliances.

However, don't expect this any time soon, as Medfield is scheduled sometime in 2011. It's a long wait, but we're already imagining the possibilities – mobile phones that perform as well as a laptop anyone?

Buy a new keyboard, get a computer

Don't let the name fool you, we aren't really holding any contests here. What we are talking about is the ASUS Eee Keyboard. Imagine having your entire computer inside your keyboard. That's what ASUS has accomplished with this product.

The Eee Keyboard is a PC with a QWERTY, minus the number pad. In place of the numpad, lies a 5-inch 800 x 480 resolution touch screen. This keyboard comes equipped with an Intel Atom